

As I
Was Saying

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SPORTS EDITOR

TWC in Baseball

TEXAS WESTERN baseballers didn't match the TWC footballers and basketballers of the past season. But the TWC diamond team, coached by Andy Cohen, did very well indeed.

The Miners ended their season Saturday by splitting a doubleheader with New Mexico at Albuquerque. The Miners lost the first game 9-8 and won the second 5-4. They had lost to the Lobos on Friday 4-3.

Winning one out of three isn't championship baseball. Also holding New Mexico to one-run wins in the other two may please somebody but the Miners still lost those two games.

However, the three games demonstrated that TWC's team had enough ability to play New Mexico on near equal terms. And New Mexico is competitive with the best college teams in the country.

More Aid in Sight

THE MINERS ended the season with a 17-12 mark. It's only the fourth season of baseball revival at the college. Recruiting and money for scholarships have been meager. In fact, there are no board and room scholarship holders on the team.

Two scholarships are given to the team. Cohen splits those into several parts and helps a number of his players in books and tuition. He's also helped by the fact that one of his best players, Charlie West, is at the college on a football scholarship and another player pitcher Tony Harper, came to TWC on a basketball scholarship.

It's little enough in the way of financial help. George McCarty, the TWC athletic director, hopes to increase the baseball scholarships to eight, and there's the possibility that TWC will soon start going out after key players (like pitchers), as the TWC football and basketball coaches do.

No Morale Problems

MOST OF THE players on the team come from the El Paso area and have played on the local high school teams.

They have been an enthusiastic lot this season. Andy had no morale problems. They've been shuttled from one diamond to another. The closest place they could get for a workout one day was at Ascarate. All the players showed with those not having cars catching rides with those who did.

Andy, who has been in baseball for a long time and has seen demonstrations of youthful enthusiasm on many other occasions, is as keenly interested in the job of coaching TWC as if he was just new at the business himself. And it's a volunteer job, with him, too.

The next big step for TWC baseball would be the securing of a campus diamond. Maybe one could be cut out of those rocky hills.